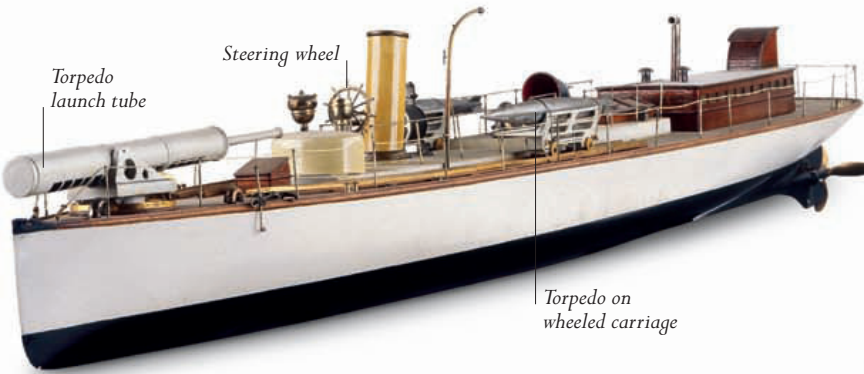


TORPEDO BOATS, DESTROYERS, AND SUBMARINES

The perfection of the locomotive torpedo by English engineer Robert Whitehead at Fiume (modern-day Rijeka) in the 1860s changed the face of naval warfare forever. Craft were soon developed specifically to deploy the new weapon, leading to the production of torpedo-boat “destroyers” to combat the threat. Destroyers quickly established themselves as a valuable component of the fleet, taking over the torpedo boats’ offensive role when necessary. The torpedo also proved vital to a third class of vessel, the submarine, as it provided submariners with a viable weapon for use when submerged against surface ships.



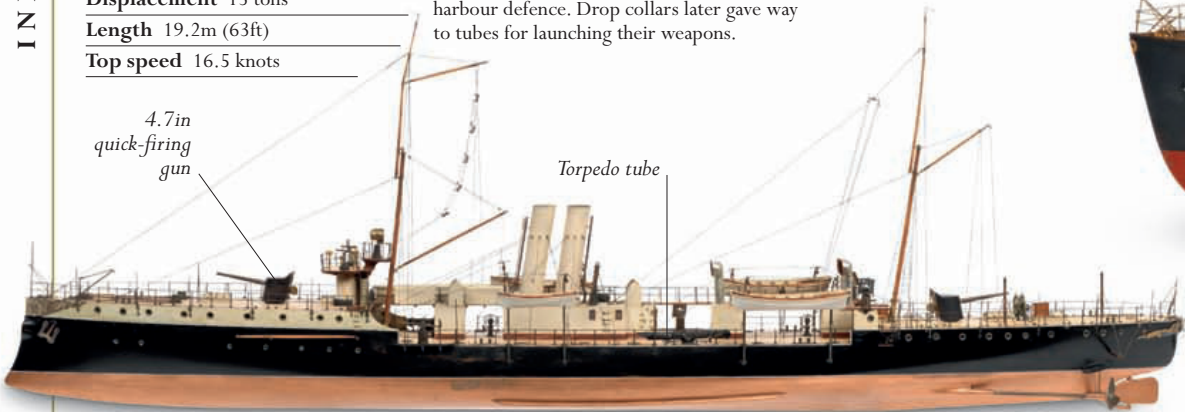
▲ **LIGHTNING**
Commissioned 1876 Origin UK
Displacement 33 tons
Length 26.7m (87½ft)
Top speed 18.5 knots

The first torpedo boat built for the British Royal Navy – at the urging of constructor John Thornycroft – was used as an experimental craft. It embodied a variety of innovative features including a divided rudder ahead of the propeller.



▲ **TB 64**
Commissioned 1880 Origin UK
Displacement 13 tons
Length 19.2m (63ft)
Top speed 16.5 knots

Second-class torpedo boats, such as the TB 64, were intended to be carried aboard battleships or large cruisers, but were also employed for harbour defence. Drop collars later gave way to tubes for launching their weapons.



▲ **ALMIRANTE SIMPSON**
Commissioned 1896 Origin Chile
Displacement 800 tons
Length 73.2m (240ft)
Top speed 21.5 knots

Strictly speaking, *Almirante Simpson* was a torpedo gunboat, very similar in design, though not in looks, to the British Royal Navy’s *Alarm*-class of 1894. This is not surprising given that it was also built by Laird in Birkenhead, England.

▼ **HMS STURGEON**
Commissioned 1896 Origin UK
Displacement 340 tons
Length 57.9m (190ft)
Top speed 27 knots

Sturgeon was one of the “27-knotters”, prototype torpedo-boat destroyers built by 14 different builders to a basic specification but no fixed pattern. It was constructed by Vickers at its Barrow-in-Furness yard, and discarded in 1912.



▲ **HMS JACKAL**
Commissioned 1911 Origin UK
Displacement 990 tons
Length 75m (246ft)
Top speed 27 knots

Jackal was an *Acheron*-class destroyer ordered under the British Royal Navy’s 1910–11 Programme. It was designed for sturdiness and good seakeeping over speed.

